

Medical Billing Training Course

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Module 1: What is Medical Billing?

Medical Billing is the process of submitting and following up on claims with health insurance companies to receive payment for services rendered by healthcare providers. It involves translating healthcare services into billing codes, creating claims, and ensuring proper reimbursement.

Key Areas: Charge Entry - Entering patient charges with correct CPT and ICD-10 codes

Claim Submission - Creating and sending claims (EDI 837 or CMS-1500)

Payment Posting - Applying insurance payments and patient payments to accounts

Denial Management - Identifying, investigating, and resolving claim denials

AR Follow-up - Tracking unpaid claims and collecting revenue

Module 2: Medical Billing Process Flow

1. Patient Registration - Collect demographics, insurance info, copy of card

2. Insurance Verification - Verify eligibility, benefits, copay, deductible

3. Pre-Authorization - Get approval for procedures requiring prior auth

4. Patient Visit - Doctor provides services, documents in EHR

5. Medical Coding - Assign ICD-10 (diagnosis) + CPT (procedure) codes

6. Charge Entry - Enter charges into billing system

7. Claim Scrubbing - Auto validation checks for errors

8. Claim Submission - Submit electronically via clearinghouse

9. Payment Posting - Post ERA/835 payments from insurance

10. Patient Billing - Bill patient for remaining balance

11. Follow-up - AR calling for unpaid claims

Module 3: Key Billing Codes

ICD-10 Codes (Diagnosis):

R07.9 - Chest Pain

E11.9 - Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus

I10 - Essential Hypertension

J06.9 - Upper Respiratory Infection

M54.5 - Low Back Pain

F32.9 - Major Depressive Disorder

CPT Codes (Procedures):

99213 - Office Visit (Level 3)

99214 - Office Visit (Level 4)

99215 - Office Visit (Level 5)

99385 - Preventive Visit (New Patient)

85025 - Complete Blood Count

80053 - Metabolic Panel

93000 - ECG (12-Lead)

Module 4: CMS-1500 Form Fields

The CMS-1500 is the standard claim form for professional services:

Box 1: Type of Insurance (Medicare, Medicaid, BCBS, etc.)

Box 1a: Insured ID Number

Box 2-6: Patient Name, DOB, Gender, Address

Box 8: Patient Status (Single, Married, Other)

Box 9: Other Insured Name (if secondary)

Box 11: Insured Policy Group Number

Box 12-13: Patient/Insured Signature

Box 14: Date of Illness/Injury

Box 21: Diagnosis Codes (ICD-10)

Box 24: CPT Codes, Units, charges, Days

Box 25: Tax ID Number

Box 31: Rendering Provider Signature

Box 33: Billing Provider Info + NPI

Module 5: Insurance Types

Government Insurance:

Medicare - Federal program for patients 65+ or disabled
Medicaid - State program for low-income patients
TRICARE - Military/veterans insurance
VA Benefits - Veterans Affairs healthcare

Private Insurance:

HMO (Health Maintenance Organization) - Need PCP referral for specialists
PPO (Preferred Provider Organization) - More flexibility, higher cost
EPO (Exclusive Provider Organization) - No referrals needed, in-network only
POS (Point of Service) - Mix of HMO and PPO
HDHP (High Deductible Health Plan) - Lower premiums, higher deductible

Module 6: Payment & Adjustment Types

Billed Amount - Total amount charged by provider
Allowed Amount - Maximum insurance will pay for the service
Contractual Adjustment - Difference between billed and allowed (write-off)
Copay - Fixed amount patient pays at visit (\$20-\$50)
Coinsurance - Percentage patient pays (usually 20%)
Deductible - Amount patient pays before insurance kicks in
Patient Responsibility - Copay + Coinsurance + Deductible
Payment Calculation: Billed \$500 | Allowed \$400 | Write-off \$100 | Insurance \$320 | Patient \$80

Module 7: Claim Scrubbing Checks

Patient DOB correct
Insurance ID verified
NPI valid and active
CPT/ICD codes match (procedure matches diagnosis)
No duplicate charges
Modifier present if needed
Filing limit not exceeded
Provider is credentialed

Module 8: Common Denial Reasons & Fixes

CO-4 - Procedure Code Issue

Fix: Check for duplicate/bundled codes, add modifier

CO-16 - Missing Claim Info

Fix: Add missing diagnosis, referral, or patient info

CO-23 - Exceeds Auth Amount

Fix: Adjust to authorized amount or appeal

CO-29 - Filing Deadline

Fix: Appeal with valid reason for late filing

CO-109 - Provider Not in Network

Fix: Verify network status, balance bill patient

CO-197 - No Prior Authorization

Fix: Get retro authorization or appeal

PR-1 - Patient Deductible

Fix: Bill patient for deductible amount

PR-2 - Patient Coinsurance

Fix: Bill patient for coinsurance percentage

PR-3 - Patient Copay

Fix: Bill patient for copay amount

NCS - Non-Covered Services

Fix: Check other insurance, bill patient

DUP - Duplicate Claim

Fix: Find and work the original claim

DTF - Timely Filing

Fix: Appeal with proof of timely filing

Module 9: ERA/EOB Reading

ERA (Electronic Remittance Advice) - Sent to Provider:

EDI 835 format - electronic payment advice

Contains: Claim#, Paid amount, Patient responsibility, Denial codes

EOB (Explanation of Benefits) - Sent to Patient:

Shows: What insurance paid, what patient owes, deductible remaining

Sent by insurance company directly to patient

Payment Posting from ERA:

1. Match claim# in system
2. Post insurance payment amount
3. Post contractual adjustment
4. Transfer patient responsibility
5. If denied - work the denial per AR calling process

Module 10: Medical Billing Key Terms

CMS-1500: Standard claim form for professional services

EDI 837: Electronic Data Interchange claim format

EDI 835: Electronic Remittance Advice (ERA)

Clean Claim: Claim with no errors, ready for processing

Scrubs: Auto-validation checks before submission

Clearinghouse: Middleman that forwards claims to insurance

Remittance: Payment + explanation from insurance

Contractual Adjustment: Difference between billed and allowed amount

Coordination of Benefits: Determines which insurance pays first

Balance Billing: Billing patient for amount above allowed

Credentialing: Process of becoming an approved insurance provider

Re-pricing: Third-party recalculating the allowed amount

Capitation: Provider gets paid per patient per month, not per visit

Provision AR Training Center

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Good luck with your Medical Billing career!